

SPECIAL PROGRAM OR ACADEMY DIVISION-WIDE PROGRAM PLACEMENT

This regulation outlines the procedures for Special Programs placement, Virginia High School League (VHSL) implications, and rescinding a student's placement in special programs across grade levels due to academic performance or behavioral concerns. The regulation aims to provide a structured, yet flexible, framework for schools while giving final authority to the building principal. This regulation applies to all students enrolled in a special program in Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) at a location other than their regular school of assignment.

A. Special Programs Admission.

1. Each special program will establish an Admissions Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) and post admissions information on the program's website. Admissions criteria should be aligned to the goals and objectives of the specific special program.

B. Special Programs VHSL Implications.

1. A student who has been accepted to participate in a special program and is being placed in the program is eligible for VHSL Activities and Athletics immediately upon enrollment.

2. After enrollment and participation in the special program, if an out-of-zone student decides to unenroll from the program and remain enrolled at the school housing the special program, the student is ineligible to participate in VHSL Activities and Athletics for 90 school days.

3. After enrollment and participation in the special program, if an out-of-zone student decides to unenroll and return to their regular school of assignment, the student will be eligible to participate in VHSL Activities and Athletics immediately upon their enrollment back at their regular school of assignment.

C. Program Rescindment.

1. Grounds for Rescindment.

a. Placement in a special program may be reviewed and potentially rescinded under the following conditions:

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- (i) Academic Concerns. The student consistently fails to meet the academic standards established by the program despite intervention efforts.
- (ii) Behavioral Concerns. The student exhibits behavior that:
 - (a) Disrupts the learning environment;
 - (b) Violates the LCPS Student Code of Conduct;
 - (c) Hinders the educational progress of others despite intervention efforts; or
 - (d) In the case of students enrolled in NJROTC: Meets the cadet disenrollment policy outlined in the Department of the Navy Regulations for Citizenship Development (RCD) program.
- (iii) Attendance Concerns. The student consistently or chronically fails to meet LCPS attendance requirements as set forth in [Policy 8140](#) (Student Attendance Requirements and Procedures) and [Regulation 8140-REG](#).

2. Intervention and Documentation.

- a. Before rescinding a student's placement, the school must implement appropriate interventions to support the student. Such interventions include:
 - (i) Academic support plans (e.g., tutoring, additional resources).
 - (ii) Behavioral interventions (e.g., counseling, behavior contracts).
 - (iii) Attendance support plans (e.g., attendance conference, attendance plan).

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- b. The school administration shall document all interventions and maintain records of meetings with the student and their parent(s)/guardian(s) regarding the concerns and outcomes.
- 3. Review Process.
 - a. The principal or designee will review the student's progress and compliance with established program standards.
 - b. If the interventions do not lead to improvement, the principal may initiate a formal review, consulting with relevant staff and the program coordinator.
 - c. The principals have the authority to make the final decision on rescinding the student's placement in the program.
- 4. Communication and Appeals.
 - a. The principal or designated administrator shall notify the parent(s)/guardian(s) in writing of the decision, including the reasons for rescindment and any actions taken before this decision.
 - b. Parents/guardians may appeal the decision through the standard LCPS appeal process outlined in [Policy 2350](#) (Appeal of Administrative Decisions).
- 5. Transition Planning:
 - a. If a student's placement is rescinded, the school will work with the student and family to ensure a smooth transition to their regular school of assignment.

Adopted: 04/02/2025

Leg Ref:

Cross Ref: [Policy 5115](#), Special Programs and Academies; [Policy 8140](#), Student Attendance Requirements and Procedures; [Regulation 8140-REG](#), Student Attendance Requirements and Procedures; [Policy 2350](#), Appeal of Administrative Decisions